Why I want to work in *publishing*

Not just because I love books.
Every good reader loves books.
I want a hand in the **making** of books.

Partha Sarathi Patra

EDITING · RESEARCH · TRANSLATION, ENGLISH AND BENGALI

DESIGN AND TEXT © 2026 PARTHA SARATHI PATRA

One loop, running *backwards* as often as *forwards*.

Reading 01
taking the world in

Thinking 02
giving it a structure

Writing 03
turning it into a claim

Editing 04
making it reach someone

TURNED INWARD



It closes when an editor, a developer or a strategist understands the ideas.

TURNED OUTWARD



It closes when it is ultimately published and the readers read the text.

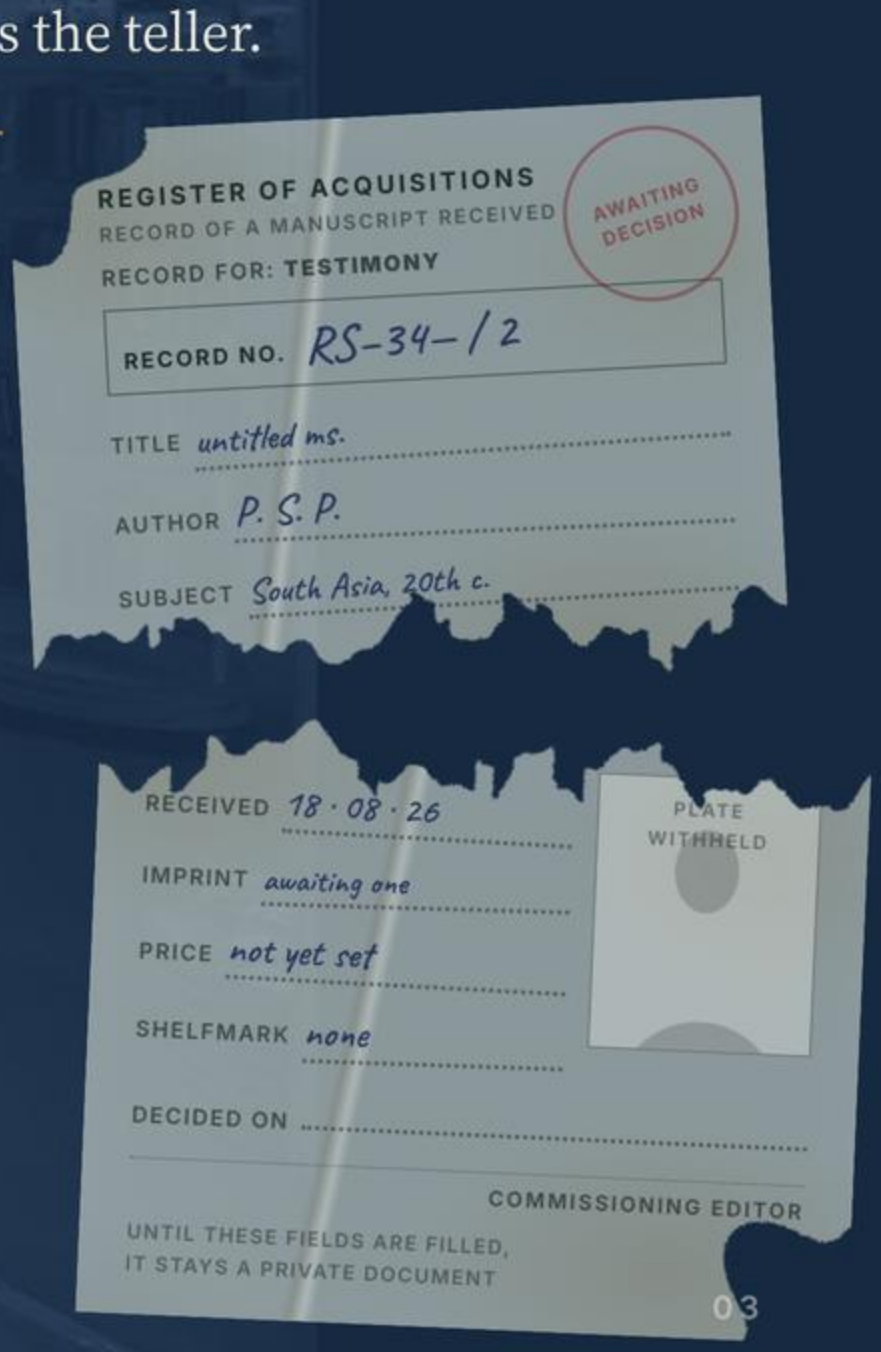
Publishing is that loop **turned outward** — run for **somebody else's book** instead of my own. That turn is the whole distance between **a draft and a book**.

The motivation behind working in this *sector*

History, literature and lived experience have taught me that there have always been aspects of our lives, our society, our culture and our politics that **lack rightful representation** — aspects that could resist the **prevailing hegemonic discourses**. I would like to work towards bringing those to the reading public.

Someone has to decide that a testimony deserves a print run, a price and a place in a catalogue. Until that decision is taken, it stays a **private document**.

I would like to be among the people who take it — and who make sure the telling survives the teller.



Different operations, and the different demands, of the *publishing industry*

A manuscript does not publish itself. It requires editorial, development, strategy and marketing — **different operations under different names** — before it can become publishable, and at last available to a reading public.

Advances in technology, AI models included, cannot replace the **human creativity** this industry demands. Can they augment it? Maybe!

What no model can do is decide what deserves to be made, or answer to the author whose work it is. Those remain **human judgements**, taken by named people at named desks.

AT THE EDITORIAL DESK

- *fact-check every claim*
- *structure the manuscript*
- *commission a reader's report*
- *clear permissions & credits*
- *line-edit, then proof*

AT THE DEVELOPMENT DESK

- *shape the brief*
- *query the author*
- *rebuild the chapters*
- *apparatus, notes & index*
- *comparable titles, schedule, specs*



I also write to make sense of the worlds I *live in*

Writing has always been my way of making sense of the world — its silences, its violence, and its quiet moments of grace. These poems emerge from **lived experience**, from the **margins**, and from a deep belief in the power of words to **witness, resist, and heal**.

I archive them out. I know the shape of the wait from the inside — which is a **qualification**, not a hobby, for an editor or developer. A creator's work that has **never been edited or developed** by someone else has **never been published**.

Life is not a rat race
to be won and lost;
rather it is a sojourn
to relish and
remember with all
your potential.

KANCHANJUNGA

But if a king could
answer catastrophe
with four minarets,
then our energetic
walk around it is our
own thanksgiving.

CHARMINAR

হোঁচট খেতে খেতে, মুখ থুবড়ে
পড়লেও উঠে দাঁড়িয়ে একা
জীবনে এগিয়ে যেতে হয়।

মানবিক ভাবে

Let us not be proud of
our disabilities, but of
our capabilities and
preferences.

BEYOND "PRIDE"

Over and above all,
hope remains the self's
sole enzyme that
makes us think of
becoming better in
newer times.

NEW YEAR'S RESOLUTION

বাংলায় পরিবর্তনের নবজাগরণ
আমরা দেখিয়াছি, বঞ্চনা,
হতাশা ও হীনমন্যতায় বাঁচিতে
চাই না আর।।

পরিবর্তনের নবজাগরণ

Not mere enthusiasm.
Trained hands.

Published materials exist only because, beyond the first author, many others wanted them **printed or digitised properly**. I bring to the industry research training, editorial training, training in **Bengali and English translation**, teaching experience, and a rejection folder of my own.

Three questions stand between a manuscript and a published text. Is it true? Is it needed? **How will it be remembered by its readers?** I would like to be one of the people who help answer each of them.



DESIGN AND TEXT © 2026 PARTHA SARATHI PATRA · JACKET IMAGES © THEIR RESPECTIVE PUBLISHERS, SHOWN FOR REFERENCE